

A photograph of a dark blue rectangular sign with the words "URBAN" and "OUTFITTERS" in bright yellow, bold, sans-serif capital letters. The sign is mounted on a building with classical architectural details like columns and cornices. The sign is slightly tilted upwards to the right.

URBAN  
OUTFITTERS

Fig 1.

# MARKETING REPORT

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Module: Fashion Marketing  
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# Executive Summary

Founded in 1970 in Pennsylvania, Urban Outfitters is built on the values of **self-expression, connection, inclusivity and creativity**. The brand continues to provide unique retail experiences, offering everything from men's and women's fashion to houseware, music, and tech. With a diverse audience, Urban Outfitters creates a sense of community among like-minded, creative individuals.

Urban Outfitters owns three proprietary brands: **lets Frans** which embraces modern streetwear inspired by sportswear essentials, **Kimchi Blue** which gives off vintage charm and whimsical romance, and **BDG**, which focuses on everyday casuals, mainly denim. It is also a part of URBN, a portfolio of global consumer brands that includes Anthropologie, Free People, FP Movement, Terrain, and Nuuly. URBN's driving force is creativity, guided by its core values: **integrity in communication and collaboration, respect for the planet and each other, building the future through creative entrepreneurship, and nurturing meaningful connections with customers and employees.**

In Europe, Urban Outfitters' largest markets are the UK and Germany. The major hurdles they are experiencing currently are the rise of fast-fashion competitors like Shein and Temu and the notion that sustainability is expensive, causing a roadblock to appeal to Gen Z consumers who value sustainability, individuality and transparency.

This report aims to develop a strategy for restoring Kimchi Blue, one of Urban Outfitter's proprietary labels. The strategy will address challenges while staying aligned with the brand's ethos of creativity and connecting with Gen Z through subcultures, style tribes, and music. Insights from competitor analysis and market research in the UK and Germany will inform the approach. Additionally, the report will examine Kimchi Blue's brand identity and positioning, and explore sustainability and price sensitivity to ensure the brand remains relevant and appealing to consumers.



Fig 2.



Fig 3.

# METHODOLOGY

My research methodology involved conducting secondary research, including analysing case studies, articles, and statistics. I also drew conclusions based on the available resources to develop an effective strategy.

# CONSUMER ANALYSIS

*“Gen-Z is the largest generation, accounting for around 25 per cent of the world’s population, and has an outsized impact on culture and economy.”*  
(The Business of Fashion 2022)

## DEMOGRAPHIC

Urban Outfitters caters to young individuals between the ages of 14 and 24, majorly members of Generation Z or GenZ (born between 1997 and 2012). This target group includes working students and recent college graduates seeking full-time job opportunities, showing a customer base that is at the transitional stage of education and early career development.



## BEHAVIOURAL

Due to constant exposure to digital technologies, Generation Z consumers are heavy users of social media, seeking news, expressing concerns, and advocating for causes it. This leads to them staying informed and connecting with others. Also, they value both experiences and appreciate tangible objects complimenting their lifestyle and interests.

Fig 4.



# CONSUMER ANALYSIS

***“When coming to an analysis of Genz, they represent an estimated \$450bn (£353bn) in spending power across the world.”  
(BBC 2023).***

## Gen Z's Influence on Fashion

The fashion industry prioritises youth as young consumers entering the workforce who would drive new trends and buying behaviours (The Business of Fashion 2022). Gen Z's fashion choices reflect their core values of authenticity, individuality, and transparency. Unlike traditional trickle-down influence, aesthetics like Barbiecore, Cottagecore, and Dark Academia show a trickle-up effect from social media. They use these trend elements in their personal styles rather than following trends completely. Their digital prowess makes the trend discovery and creation fast through platforms like TikTok, Instagram, and Snapchat. (BOF 2022)

## Gen Z: “Knows everything” Shopper

Gen Z uses digital resources to research, compare, and evaluate products before purchasing. Despite being price-conscious, they prioritise quality and are willing to delay purchases for the best deals without compromising on standards. (BBC 2023) They highly value product reviews, and readily seek alternatives if products fail to meet their expectations. This wise approach makes them shrewd and influential consumers. (Talon.One 2024)

## Gen Z: Advocates for Ethics, Individuality, and Shopping Versatility

Gen Z values self-expression and supports brands committed to ethical practices, inclusivity, and mental health. They voice concerns against unethical practices while prioritising brand ethics and corporate responsibility more than previous generations. (Talon.One 2024) Despite being frequent social media shoppers, they appreciate in-store shopping for its tangible experience and personalised service. (Clear Channel 2024) Gen Z has high expectations for customer service, product quality, and individualised shopping experiences tailored to their preferences. (Printful 2024)

# EMERGING CONSUMER TRENDS

## SUSTAINABLE FASHION

Environmental consciousness is one of Gen Z's major concerns, reflected in their fashion choices and trends. A 2020 survey revealed that 66% of Gen Z shoppers are willing to pay more for sustainable or environmentally friendly products. (Printful 2024)

## RESALE MARKET

The global secondhand apparel market is set to grow three times faster than the global apparel market, with Gen Z leading sustainability. Due to the cost-of-living crisis, Gen Z will continue to power the thrift movement in search of more affordable alternatives. Also, Gen Z are selling their pre-loved clothes to declutter (50%), for sustainability (33%) and to get extra money (56%). (WGSN Insider 2024)

# CONSUMERS IN THE UK AND GERMANY

*“In the BoF-McKinsey State of Fashion 2025 Executive Survey, consumer confidence and appetite to spend was ranked by fashion executives as the top risk to growth” (BoF Insights 2025)*

## UK and German Consumer Behaviour

Over 40% of shoppers in the US, UK, and Germany are reducing their spending on fashion, with over 60% actively seeking to save money on clothing, footwear, and accessories. This trend reflects cautious consumer behaviour, which can be a top risk to industry growth. Across income levels, shoppers are adopting trade-down behaviours:

- Value and mid-market consumers favour outlets, off-price retailers, and price comparisons.
- Premium consumers are increasingly using “buy now, pay later” services (16%), and resale platforms (23%), and opting for cheaper replicas or “dupes” of desired products. (BoF Insights, 2025)

Even as economic conditions improve, over 80% of consumers plan to spend the same or less on fashion in 2025. Consumers are shifting their priorities and allocating discretionary spending toward experiences like dining out and travel over fashion, denoting an “inflation overhang.” (BoF Insights, Company 2025)

## A look at German and UK Gen Z

Mintel’s 2024 report shows similarities between them are in valuing social media influence, affordability, and ethical production, though cost often limits sustainable choices. Yet, UK Gen Z prioritises appearance, travel, and nostalgic fashion, while German Gen Z emphasises self-expression, quality, and second-hand fashion. Viral trends dominate in the UK, thrifted fashion is key in Germany. Financially, UK Gen Z relies more on family support, while German Gen Z focuses on value-driven purchases. Market opportunities include nostalgia and beauty trends in the UK and ethical, second-hand fashion in Germany. (Mintel, 2024)



# COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

Due to a diverse merchandise mix, Urban Outfitters is able to compete with a large variety of retailers. Its main competitors are Shein, Temu, Zara, H&M and ASOS. While these competitors share some overlapping target demographics, especially in the age group of 14-24 years old, they each have different strategies and positioning that set them apart.

## Pricing

When it comes to pricing, Urban Outfitters is slightly premium compared to H&M, Shein, Temu and ASOS but more affordable than Zara.

## Target Audience

ASOS targets both millennials and Gen Z with an inclusive approach, offering diverse styles for self-expression and various body types (The Brand Hopper 2024b). Zara appeals to fashion-conscious individuals by delivering premium, designer-inspired trends at affordable prices (Brand Vision Insights 2023). H&M caters to budget-conscious shoppers, providing affordable basics and

essentials, ideal for younger consumers building versatile wardrobes (The Brand Hopper 2024a). Shein and Temu focus on ultra-budget-conscious Gen Z customers, offering low-priced, trend-driven items to meet the demand for constant newness (Supdropshipping 2024). Urban Outfitters, meanwhile, targets creative and trendy Gen Z individuals aged 14-24 who value individuality.

## Marketing Strategies

Urban Outfitters takes a multifaceted approach to marketing, stressing the creation of a cohesive brand identity and encouraging an emotional connection through a sense of community with its Gen Z target audience. The company uses social media platforms extensively, using visually appealing content and influencer partnerships. They believe in in-store experiences and for that in order to attract customers they design the store aesthetically giving it a visual appeal (FashionUnited 2015). It also creates a sense of community of like-minded creative individuals through their workshops or publishing their SHEET



# COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

magazine which has creative artworks of various artists (Urban Outfitters 2022). In contrast, many of Urban Outfitters' competitors, such as Zara and H&M, adopt a more straightforward, transactional marketing strategy, majorly using social media and influencer collaboration to stay ahead of emerging fashion trends and drive customer engagement. Fast-fashion giants like Shein and Temu also utilise social media trends and influencer marketing and a heavy load of Search Engine Optimisation tactics, but their marketing seems more transactional, centred around showcasing product offerings and affordability rather than making deeper emotional connections (Scmr 2023). They make their app fun by gamification of coupon discoveries, which adds an element of fun to it (Medium 2024). ASOS adopts a more balanced approach, combining social media and influencer marketing strategies with a strong online presence and a user-friendly website experience. However, ASOS' brand identity is generally perceived as more inclusive, rather than the distinct and trend-focusing aesthetic that Urban Outfitters has created.

## **The Havoc**

The rapid rise of Shein and Temu has undoubtedly caused significant disruption and, in some cases, complete disasters for many traditional e-commerce players. For example, Shein and Temu's massive ad spend on platforms like Google

and Meta has driven up the costs of customer acquisition for competitors. Etsy's CEO noted this and realised that such acts were impacting their business. Also, established retailers like Gap have reported that Shein is rapidly gaining market share and competing directly for their customer base. The speed and scale at which Shein and Temu can bring new products to market makes it challenging for traditional brands to keep up. (Modern Retail 2023)

Their fast-fashion model enables them to quickly respond to social media trends, adding hundreds of new items daily and dominating platforms like TikTok, where they have a 42% percentage of #hauls content for Shein (Modern Retail 2023). Also, their supply chain plays a big role here too. Shein and Temu's dominance in e-commerce stems from their fast supply chains, taking advantage of manufacturing proximity, vendor networks, and optimised logistics for unmatched speed, efficiency, and cost-effectiveness. This allows them to swiftly turn social media trends into affordable, diverse products, leaving competitors struggling to adapt their models to this new standard (Scmr 2023).

Due to all this, the fashion industry is undergoing a rapid transformation, forcing traditional fashion brands to adapt or risk becoming obsolete in front of these agile, digitally advanced competitors.

# KEY INSIGHTS

Urban Outfitters operates at the intersection of cultural, and generational shifts, presenting both challenges and opportunities (See Appendix 1 and 2). The brand's identity: creativity and individuality, now competes with ultra-fast fashion giants like Shein and Temu. The methods used by them to stay relevant is a paradox that Urban Outfitters faces: the rise of fast fashion and sustainability versus affordability.

Central to this challenge is Gen Z, who want ethical consumption. The rise of social media has further complicated the fashion industry, pushing it into an "ultra-fast fashion" era dominated by brands like Shein and Temu. These companies use influencer-driven trends and instant gratification to captivate consumers, particularly Gen Z. A report reveals that 62% of Gen Z shoppers prefer to buy from sustainable brands, and a staggering 73% are willing to pay more for sustainable products. (First Insight 2024) Urban Outfitters needs to adapt to challenges like inflation and lower spending by Gen Z. To stay relevant, it should personalise experiences, create immersive connections, and make sustainability a core part of the brand. Also, Urban Outfitters could gain trust more easily, as it does not have lawsuits regarding ethical practices compared to Shein and Temu. Urban Outfitters' approach must also consider Gen Z subcultures and style tribes, which reflect the generation's search for identity and community. (Pion 2023) Tribes shaped by niche interests, often discovered on platforms like TikTok, represent an evolution of traditional fashion subcultures like punk, goth, Cottagecore, etc. promoting inclusivity and experimentation. (Flannels 2024)

Music shapes the identity of Gen Z tribes, with genres like hip-hop, indie, and electronic fostering community. Platforms like Spotify enhance this connection through features like collaborative playlists and Spotify Wrapped. (Spotify 2022).

Retailers can engage Gen Z by curating playlists of mainstream and indie music for in-store, playing licensed tracks to respect the artist. (Jukeboxy 2024). TikTok highlights the link between music and fashion, directing trends like Lil Nas X's Old Town Road and showcasing Gen Z's love for genre-blending. (Genz Explained 2024).

Sustainability in the fashion industry presents a complex challenge, particularly the tension between pricing and consumer adoption.

***"There isn't anything at a mass level at scale that is a viable alternative to fast fashion," said Sherman. "It's difficult to get people to stop drinking Coke until you offer them Diet Coke."***(The Business of Fashion 2020)

Gen Z's commitment to environmental and social responsibility is evidenced by their willingness to pay higher prices for sustainable products. Consumers are willing to pay more if they know the reasons, especially for sustainable products. A study reported that in 2015, 66% were willing to pay more, which has now risen to 80%. (Kearney 2020).

Around 70% of consumers are willing to pay up to 10% more, a sustainability

Fig 11.

# KEY INSIGHTS

markup is widely accepted, potentially driving mass adoption and expanding sustainable product distribution (Kearney 2020).

Gen Z shows notable dedication to sustainability, with 82% expressing concern about the planet and 72% actively changing their behaviour to reduce environmental impact (MediaCat 2023). Their buying decisions show a growing preference for their core values, motivated by increased awareness of climate change and environmental issues.

In today's world, where not everything we do can be sustainable, even small efforts can make people feel good about themselves.

Urban Outfitters should focus on spreading sustainability while adapting to Gen Z's interests in style tribes, music, and ethical retail experiences to succeed and stay profitable.





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URBAN  
OUTFITTERS

Fig 1.

# BRAND PITCH

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Date: 27th January 2025



# INTRODUCTION



The main aim of my report is to create a strategic marketing plan to refresh the Kimchi Blue brand, aligning it with Urban Outfitters' ethos of creativity and connection. I started by exploring the reasons behind key challenges such as the growing popularity of hyper-fast fashion, concerns about sustainability, and the price sensitivity of Gen Z consumers. Drawing from competitor analysis and market research in the UK and Germany, I created a strategy to make Kimchi Blue more relevant by tapping into subcultures, style tribes, and music preferences that appeal to the target audience.

I also analysed Kimchi Blue's brand identity and positioning using marketing tools like Ansoff's Matrix, the BCG Matrix, and Porter's Five Forces. This helped me to understand how the brand can have sustainability while staying true to the values of Gen Z. My goal is to ensure Kimchi Blue maintains its unique identity while staying competitive and attractive in today's dynamic fashion industry.

Fig 2.

# THE BRIEF

How can Urban Outfitters expand its product offering by rebooting an existing proprietary brand while addressing the challenges of hyper-fast fashion, price sensitivity, and sustainability without compromising its brand identity and values?

It involves understanding the consumer (14-24 years old in the UK and Germany), analysing competitors, inculcating cultural elements (subcultures, style tribes, and music), and positioning Urban Outfitters effectively against hyper-fashion brands like SHEIN and TEMU.

# THE SOLUTION

To find a solution to the brief, we need to first attain SMART goals.

**S**

**M**

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**T**

In our case, it would be increasing brand awareness related to sustainability and sales of Kimchi Blue by 15% in the UK and German markets by the end of this year.

# ANSOFF MATRIX

## Market Penetration

- **Strategy:** Increase market share with existing products in existing markets.
- **Application to Kimchi Blue:**
  - Enhance marketing efforts for bestsellers like romantic dresses or vintage-inspired tops in current markets.
  - Offer promotions, loyalty programs, or collaborations with influencers to attract more customers from the same demographic.

## Market Development

- **Strategy:** Expand into new geographic or demographic markets.
- **Application to Kimchi Blue:**
  - Expand availability to emerging markets like Asia or South America
  - Target new demographics, such as older consumers who appreciate timeless, elegant designs or Gen Z consumers via trendy digital campaigns.

## Product Development

- **Strategy:** Introduce new styles, collaborations, or product categories.
- **Application to Kimchi Blue:**
  - Develop eco-friendly product lines to appeal to the growing demand for sustainable fashion.
  - Collaborate with designers or influencers to release limited-edition collections.

## Diversification

- **Strategy:** Expand into entirely new product areas or customer segments.
- **Application to Kimchi Blue:**
  - Explore related segments such as home décor with a romantic, vintage-inspired aesthetic.



# PORTER'S FIVE FORCES

## **Threat of New Entrants:** Moderate

- Kimchi blue has moderate barriers. While new brands can enter with ease due to low capital requirements, establishing a brand identity like Kimchi Blue is challenging.
- Competing against established brands requires significant marketing and investments.

## **Supplier Power:** Low to Moderate

- Kimchi Blue has Urban Outfitters' established supply chain, which likely gives it strong negotiating power over suppliers.
- Reliance on specific materials (e.g., lace, soft fabrics) could pose a risk if suppliers raise costs or face disruptions.

## **Buyer Power:** High

- Kimchi Blue's customers are highly price-sensitive primarily Gen Z
- With a plethora of alternatives in the market buyers have the power to switch brands easily if pricing or design does not meet expectations.
- The brand mitigates this by offering a unique aesthetic and leveraging Urban Outfitters' loyalty programs.

## **Threat of Substitutes:** High

- Substitutes for Kimchi Blue's products include other affordable vintage-inspired clothing brands, fast fashion brands, and even second-hand/vintage clothing stores.
- The rise of thrift shopping and sustainable fashion adds further competition.

## **Competitive Rivalry:** High

- Key competitors like Zara, Mango, and smaller boutique labels offering feminine, vintage aesthetics.

# BCG MATRIX

## **BCG Quadrant:** Question Mark

- **Market Share:** Limited, as Kimchi Blue is relatively niche, targeting a vintage-inspired, feminine clothing audience.
- **Market Growth:** Moderate growth in niche vintage/feminine clothing markets, though competition from boutique brands and second-hand markets is rising.
- **Profitability:** Moderate, relying heavily on unique designs.

## **Strategic Recommendation:**

Invest in targeted marketing to amplify brand awareness and emphasise exclusivity. Explore partnerships or capsule collections to expand visibility.

# STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

After going through the analysis by using different models, it is derived that a **Product Development** strategy should be implemented by launching a sustainable fashion line to rejuvenate the brand and meet evolving consumer demands.

**Justification:**

## Porter's Five Forces Analysis

- **Competitive Rivalry:** The fashion industry is highly competitive
- **Threat of New Entrants:** A strong brand identity focused on sustainability can deter new entrants.
- **Bargaining Power of Buyers:** Offering sustainable pieces will cause buyer loyalty.
- **Threat of Substitutes:** Vintage boutiques and shops can be a threat

## BCG Matrix Positioning

- Kimchi Blue is currently a **Cash Cow** with a stable market share in a mature market.

## Ansoff Matrix Application

-The strategy aligns with **Product Development**.

## Why Kimchi Blue?

### 1. Brand Positioning:

- Kimchi Blue is known for its feminine, vintage-inspired aesthetic.

### 2. Market Potential:

- Gen Z consumers favor timeless, vintage and sustainable pieces.

### 3. Cultural Resonance:

- Kimchi Blue's roots can be reimaged to integrate references to music, art, and style tribes

### 4. Competitor Differentiation:

- Kimchi Blue can occupy a middle ground
-

# 'THE CAPSULE CULTURED' CAMPAIGN



Fig 3.

**Campaign Goal:** The campaign celebrates individuality, self-expression, and sustainability by crafting a narrative that resonates with Gen Z's appreciation for subcultures, vintage aesthetics, and eco-conscious values. This **capsule collection** bridges the past and present, blending whimsical vintage charm with contemporary sensibilities. Every piece tells a story, every detail matters, and every wearer becomes part of a vibrant cultural mosaic.

**Campaign Period:** March 2025 to December 2025

**Location:** United Kingdom and Germany

**Target Audience:** Urban Outfitters 14-24 years old targeted audience.

**Marketing channels:** Instagram, Tiktok and Youtube



# THE CAPSULE CULTURED CAMPAIGN

## STORYTELLING

The campaign, Lost & Found in Time, invites us on a journey of discovering hidden treasures in the modern world, blending the past and future through cultural exchange. It starts at a sunlit flea market, set in a vintage fairground with eclectic stalls. A group of friends, each reflecting a different Gen Z style tribe, wander through the market, finding unique pieces that speak to their personalities. Among the treasures, they come across a mysterious trunk labeled as “Kimchi Blue: The Capsule Cultured”.

When they open the trunk, the world around them shifts, and they are transported through time to iconic moments of subculture, like ‘90s grunge, ‘70s boho, and early 2000s indie sleaze. Each friend tries on a piece from the collection, finding themselves in vibrant scenes of vintage fairs, sunlit meadows, and urban graffiti walls. All of it feels magical.

As they explore, the timeless beauty of Kimchi Blue’s designs- tea dresses, romantic blouses, and printed playsuits reflects their individuality in those moments of joy, self-expression, and connection. Close-up shots highlight the intricate details, from lace layers to delicate embroidery, showcasing the craftsmanship behind each piece.

Returning to the present-day flea market, the friends now confidently wear their Kimchi Blue capsule collection, each embodying a unique subcultural vibe. As they stand together, a sense of community that transcends time fills the air. The camera pulls back to reveal other shoppers, also wearing Kimchi Blue pieces, signaling the rise of a growing cultural movement. (Video Advertisement Idea)





# CAMPAIGN ELEMENTS

1.

## Content Series

- **Social Media Reels:** Gen Z influencers and creators from the UK and Germany produce TikTok and Instagram reels, and YouTube Shorts under themes like:
  - “What’s in My Wardrobe?”
  - “Wardrobe Essentials”
  - “Timeless Pieces in My Closet.”
  - These reels showcase the capsule wardrobe “The Capsule Cultured,” highlighting its connection to various subcultures and its role in a sustainable lifestyle. Also, telling that the fabrics used are cotton, linen and recycled fabrics
- **Interactive Features:** Each garment’s care label includes a QR code linking to a Spotify or Apple Music playlist inspired by the corresponding subculture, blending music and fashion into an engaging experience. The QR codes build anticipation and excitement among consumers.
- **Timeline:** March



Fig 4.

# CAMPAIGN ELEMENTS

## 2.

### DIY Pop-Up Stores

- **Launch Events:** Pop-up stores in Urban Outfitters locations across the UK and Germany. Influencers and creators announce these events via social media, with additional promotions on the Urban Outfitters website and app.
- **Workshops:** Guests participate in workshops on upcycling old Kimchi Blue pieces or newly purchased items. They're taught simple embroidery techniques with provided materials, encouraging sustainable practices.
- **Interactive Displays:** Screens display videos showcasing the ethical and sustainable processes behind the capsule collection. Beneath each screen, QR codes direct attendees to Urban Outfitters' "Sustainability Diaries," a web page offering deeper insights.
- **Timeline:** April & May



Fig 5.



Fig 6.



# CAMPAIGN ELEMENTS

3.

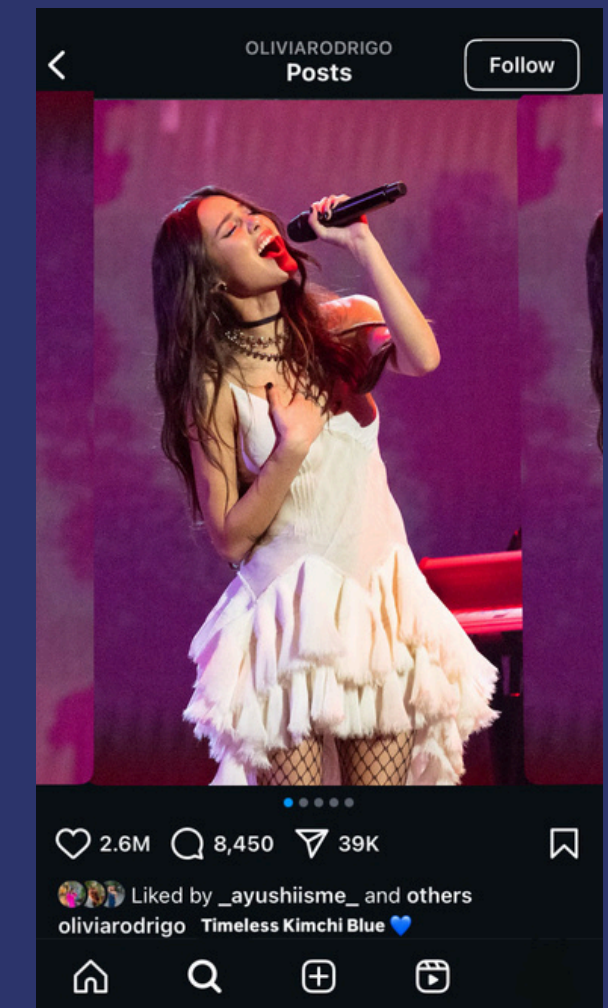
## Celebrity Collaboration

- **Partnering with Olivia Rodrigo:** The Grammy-winning singer-songwriter, known for hits like “drivers license” and “good 4 u”, connects deeply with Gen Z. The collaboration includes:
  - A social media post featuring Olivia backstage at a concert, styled in a piece from the Kimchi Blue capsule collection, tagged to Urban Outfitters Europe handle.
  - A subsequent Instagram story by Olivia promoting the campaign and highlighting its sustainability focus. This partnership generates buzz for both the brand and the artist’s eco-conscious efforts.
- **Timeline:** June



Fig 7.

Fig 8.





# CAMPAIGN ELEMENTS

4.

## Community-Driven Competitions

- **Instagram Contest:** “Design Your Dream Kimchi Blue Piece.” Participants submit sketches of a sustainable garment. The winning design is incorporated into a future collection.
- **TikTok Styling Competitions:** Themes include “Style a Kimchi Blue Outfit for Your Favorite Concert” and “DIY Your Old Kimchi Blue Piece.”
  - Prizes: Winners receive a DIY kit and £50/€50 Urban Outfitters gift cards, creating excitement and boosting engagement.
- **Timeline:** July, August and September

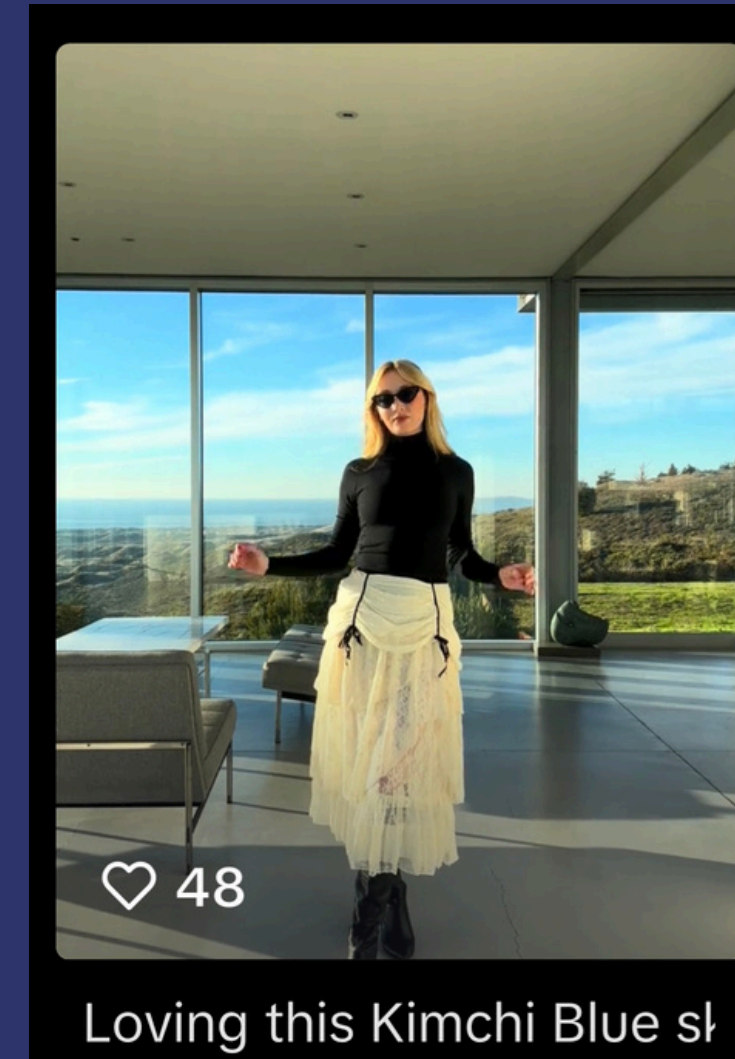


Fig 9.

Fig 10.



# AIMS AND KPIS

The Capsule Cultured campaign aims to create a dynamic, immersive experience that goes beyond fashion, fostering a sense of individuality and collective connection. By blending storytelling with sustainable practices, Kimchi Blue redefines timeless style for a new generation.

**Awareness and Reach**

**Engagement**

**Sales and Conversions**

**Sustainability and Loyalty**

**Community Building**

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# APPENDIX

## Appendix 1: SWOT analysis

### Strengths

- Diverse brand portfolio catering to different market segments. (URBN 2025)
- Providing unique store experiences in terms of layouts, aesthetics etc. (FashionUnited 2015)
- Easily adapt to fashion trends that represent their targeted demographics. (The Brand Hopper 2024)

### Weaknesses

- Reliance on its other portfolio brands for profits. (Retail Gazette 2023)
- Underperformance in comparison to other brands in the portfolio in terms of sales and revenue generated. (Retail Gazette 2023)
- Facing intense competition from established or emerging brands, for example, Zara, Shein, etc.

### Opportunities

- It can expand its e-commerce presence in areas where it already has a strong market to improve its online platforms and connect with more customers. (Ainvest 2024)
- Growing demand for sustainable and ethical fashion gives Urban Outfitters an opportunity to expand its sustainable product lines and encourage more eco-friendly initiatives. (Printful 2024)
- The company could also expand into emerging markets in Asia and Africa, which could provide new avenues for growth.

### Threats

- Changing consumer preference to current fast fashion giants like Shein and Temu. (The Business of Fashion 2023)
- International expansion will raise operational and regulatory compliance costs.
- Rise of new e-commerce platforms can decrease store footfall.

# APPENDIX

## Appendix 2: PESTLE analysis

### Political

**Tariff Regulations:** There might be challenges and adjustments that businesses can face in navigating post-Brexit trade under the EU-UK Trade and Cooperation Agreement, leading to new regulations, tariffs, and supply chain impacts. (KPMG 2021) Germany's trade surplus affects tariffs, highlighting the importance of a unified European response to economic challenges. (POLITICO 2025) This could affect Urban Outfitters as it imports a considerable percentage of its products. (ImportGenius 2025)

**Political Stability in potential Markets:** Political stability is crucial for Urban Outfitters' expansion strategies if they want to expand in other markets other than UK and Germany, otherwise it would affect them financially.

### Economic

**Consumer Purchasing Power:** Urban Outfitters can be impacted by the purchasing power of its target demographic where due to the rise of inflation, the working class in the particular targeted demographic could be left with less spending money. (Deloitte 2024) (European Commission 2024)

**Currency Exchange Rates:** Currency exchange rates impact Urban Outfitters' international sales and pricing. For example, the exchange rate for the Euro to the U.S. dollar British pound to the U.S. dollar keeps fluctuating.

**Employment Rates:** Employment rates directly affect consumer spending and an increase or decrease in it can affect the purchasing power of the consumer. (Federal Statistical Office 2025) (Statista 2024b)

# APPENDIX (PESTLE CONTINUED)

## Social Factors

**Changing Consumer Fashion Trends:** Fashion is dynamic and Urban Outfitters must adapt to evolving fashion trends for which it is famous for adopting quickly.

**Increasing Emphasis on Ethical Shopping:** Being grown up with climate change, Gen Z consumers are willing to have a sustainable retail and some even willing to pay a higher price for the item. (First Insight 2024)

## Technological Factors

**Data Analytics for Consumer Behavior:** Urban Outfitters uses data analytics to understand consumer behavior. The company invested further in AI to help with understanding its consumers. (AI magazine 2023)

**Social Media Marketing Trends:** Urban Outfitters' social media marketing has adapted to changing trends. Their Instagram and TikTok pages, and their curated playlist on Spotify creates a sense of community among its audience.

## Legal Factors

**Intellectual Property Laws:** Urban Outfitters believes in intellectual property laws to protect its brand and even the works of artists/designers they work with.

**Data Protection Laws:** The enforcement of data protection laws, particularly the GDPR in Europe and DPA in the UK, is crucial for Urban Outfitters. (GDPR 2016) (GOV.UK 2018)

## Environmental Factors

**Sustainable Sourcing Practices:** Urban Outfitters is committed to sustainable sourcing practices. As of their website, they aim to direct source a higher percentage of their raw material more responsibly by 2027 than what it is currently. (Urban Outfitters 2023)

**Carbon Footprint Reduction:** Urban Outfitters takes the initiatives like circularity, upcycling, virtual sampling and sustainability to reduce its carbon footprint. (Urban Outfitters 2023)